SINGH *is* BLING

Ranveer Singh is back at his sartorial best in *Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani*

YOU HAVE TO HAND IT TO THE MAN! Ranveer Singh has single-handedly paved the way for the movers and shakers of tinsel-town to take more risks with how they dress. Call it avant garde, eccentric, quirky, loud or whatever, Singh's style statement is an extension of his vivacious personality.

More often than not, he has carried everything off with aplomb, whether it is brocade tuxedos, floral-print shirts, or a sequinned Gucci turtleneck paired with yellow pants and silver boots. Singh has worn a blinding neon-green double-breasted suit and a full tracksuit with a silver space jacket. He wore a zebra-printed outfit at the Filmfare Awards, donned a ghaghra with a pathani and golden foil wrap. When it comes to Bollywood's fashion experimentalists, Singh makes his own rules in his fashion laboratory.

It has been no different with his latest film, *Rocky Aur Rani Kii Prem Kahaani*. As Rocky, Singh dons numerous flamboyant outfits that scream luxury, from a spiked leather jacket to hexagonal glasses, unbuttoned silk shirts that reveal a well-oiled torso and skinny-fit white jeans. Stylist Nitasha Gaurav, who has worked extensively with Singh, says, "Public opinion is not something Ranveer has ever worried about. There is only one thought at the back of his mind when he chooses to wear anything—does it make him happy?"

To hear it straight from the (clothes) horse's mouth, Singh says, "I am not at all bothered by what people think is right or wrong, or what they may or may not like. Comfort is important, and the most important thing is that I am confident that I can carry something off! It takes guts to do bizarre. And I will wear anything that appeals to my gutsy self!"

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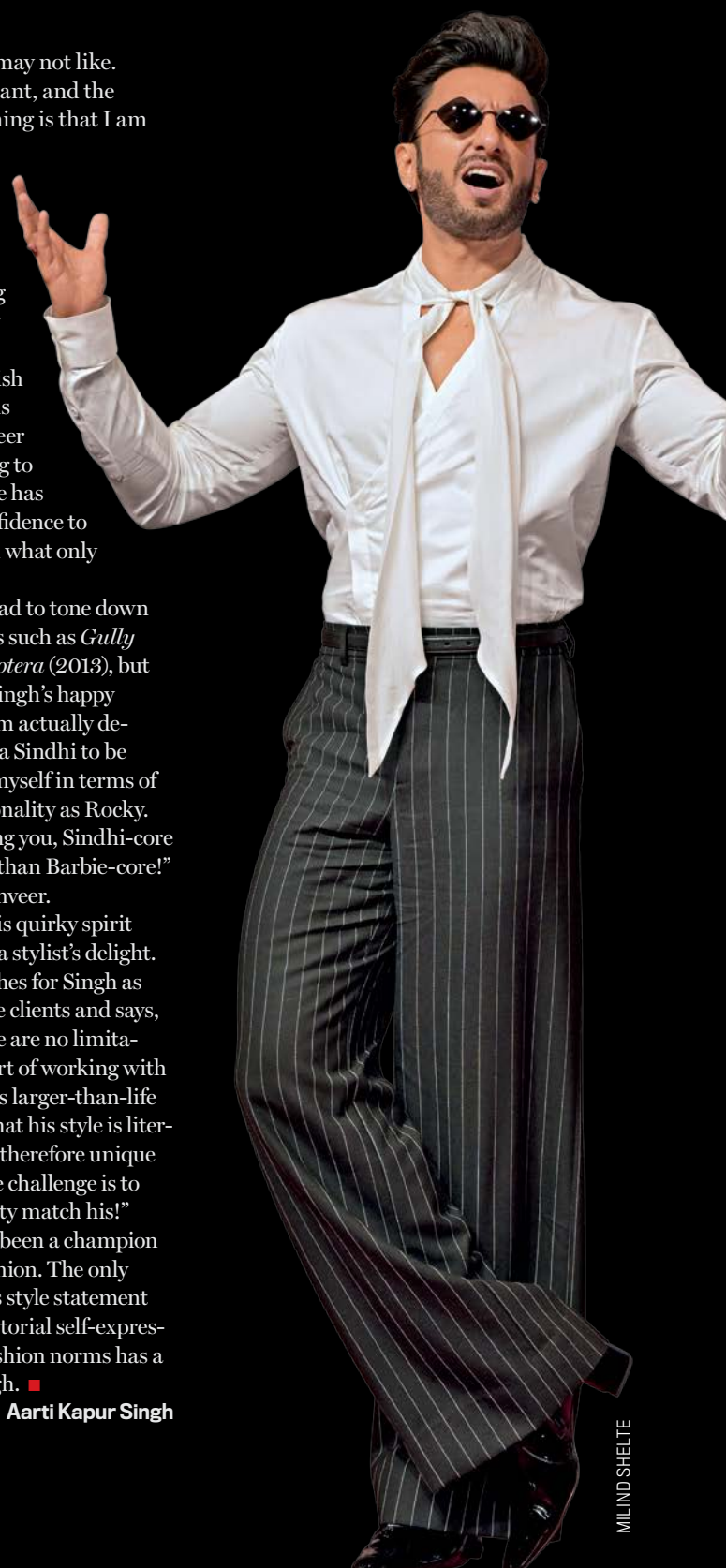
Designer Manish Malhotra lauds this confidence: "Ranveer doesn't do anything to be 'on trend', but he has that max-level confidence to create a trend with what only he can do!"

He may have had to tone down the volume in films such as *Gully Boy* (2019) and *Lootera* (2013), but flamboyance is Singh's happy space. "I am actually delighted as a Sindhi to be playing myself in terms of my personality as Rocky. I'm telling you, Sindhi-core is better than Barbie-core!" laughs Ranveer.

It is this quirky spirit that makes him a stylist's delight. Eka Lakhani vouches for Singh as one of her favourite clients and says, "The fact that there are no limitations is the best part of working with Ranveer Singh. His larger-than-life approach means that his style is literally 'invented' and therefore unique and very fresh. The challenge is to make your creativity match his!"

Singh has also been a champion of gender-fluid fashion. The only defining rule in his style statement is unapologetic sartorial self-expression. If bending fashion norms has a champion, it's Singh. ■

Aarti Kapur Singh



MILIND SHELTE